WEATHER.
Fair tonight and tomorrow; colder tonight; lowest temperature near freezing.
Temperature for twenty-four hours ended at 2 p.m. today—Highest, 61, at 4 p.m. yesterday; lowest, 37, at 10 a.m. today. Full report on page 7.

Closing New York Stocks, Page 29

The Evening Star.

WITH SUNDAY MORNING EDITION

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WASHINGTON, D. C., WEDNESDAY, MARCH 15, 1922—FORTY-FOUR PAGES.

TWO CENTS.

$10,000,000 BLAZE DESTROYS CHICAGO DOWNTOWN BLOCK

Full Square of Business Houses Just Outside "Loop" Prey of Flames.

25,000 LEFT JOBLESS; ONE FIREMAN IS KILLED

Sparks Set Dozen New Fires—Man Held as Incendiary—Six Millions in Burned Bank Vaults.

By the Associated Press.

CHICAGO, March 15.—A spectacular early morning fire today destroyed a full square of business buildings just outside Chicago's "loop," or downtown, district, with a loss estimated at from $10,000,000 to $15,000,000.

The fire, of unknown origin, started in the center of the block bounded by Van Buren, Canal and Clinton streets and West Jackson boulevard, burned every structure in that area, leaped north across Jackson and wrecked the twenty-one-story Chicago, Burlington and Quincy railroad's general office building, which also houses the Mercantile Trust and Savings Bank, and, under burden of a strong wind, dipped over Van Buren street southward and burned nearly through to Harrison street.

Fighting Dozen Fires at Once.

The fire was not brought under control until nearly 5 o'clock, and even then firemen were fighting a dozen different fires and others broke out intermittently as the wind wafted sparks about.

One fireman was killed, another seriously injured, ten or more slightly hurt and an unknown number of the hundred thousand spectators who thronged the burning district slightly hurt by falling bricks, burning timbers or sparks.

The fire for a time threatened to assume virtually unlimited proportions and every piece of fire-fighting apparatus within five miles was called out in a series of ten alarms.

Spread With Great Speed.

"The rapidity with which the fire spread was astounding," Marshall Buckley, assistant fire chief, said. "The fire actually seemed to run from us."

That the original blaze from which the conflagration grew possible was of incendiary origin was the statement of Shirley P. High, city fire attorney, who early today announced the arrest of an unnamed man on information supplied by H. T. Schiff, president of the Confectionery Specialty Company, at 521 West Jackson boulevard, where the fire started.

Mr. High refused to divulge the name of the man arrested, but said that he was being questioned regarding threatening letters Mr. Schiff said the man, a former employe, had sent to him. Mr. Schiff told Mr. High the man was discharged when he became incensed over refusal to permit him to purchase stock in the company, and within the past two months had made a series of threats. Mr. Schiff placed his personal loss at $50,000.

Places Loss Near $15,000,000.

Mr. High summoned several of his aides while the fire was at its height and said an investigation would be begun immediately. He placed the total loss at from $10,000,000 to $15,000,000.

Traversing the main burned area, the Metropolitan West Side Elevated line today was seriously handicapped in delivering its thousands of patrons to the downtown district, as was the Aurora and Elgin Electric Interurban line, which also used the four-track structure which was caught in the midst of the fire.

The huge Burlington office building, called a fireproof structure, held the fire from spreading westward, while progress of the flames toward the south was ended by the access the firemen had to the smaller buildings—to six stories—which begin south of Van Buren street.

A vacant lot, the site of the new Union depot, kept the fire from spreading northward. The Chicago river runs a block east of the burned district, but would have afforded but little protection had the wind veered the sweep of the flames toward the main business section.

Heat Drives Away Police Guard.

Heat from the burning buildings across the street cracked out the windows of the Mercantile Trust and Savings Bank before the Burlington building itself was afire. A heavy police guard was thrown about the bank, but was driven away quickly when the building caught fire.

Cash and securities valued at approximately $6,000,000 are said to be in the bank's vaults, and it may be several days before they can be examined.

The Burlington building caught fire at about the eighth story and burned up and down. No stream of water was powerful enough to fight the fire in the upper stories.

Elevated Supports at White Heat.

So intense was the heat in the burning district that the steel supports of the elevated structure could be seen at white heat.

Despite the calling out of extra policemen, automobiles of spectators quickly jammed the streets about the burning district. The flames, leaping high and puffed by the gusts of wind, were visible for more than twenty miles.

The Van Buren street tunnel of the Chicago surface lines, under the Chicago river, debouches just at the burned area, and for hours a stream of water poured into it until the tunnel was filled to street level.

The union depot mail terminal was not reached by the flames, but postal employes hurriedly removed all mail when it appeared that the fire district could not be restricted.

Cash in Vault Safe.

The Mercantile Trust and Savings Bank later announced that the cash and securities in its vaults were amply protected by heavy steel, cement and asbestos walls and that they were quite safe. Arrangements were made to have another bank take care of its business until new quarters could be obtained.

The new Burlington building withstood a heat so terrific that the fire escape on the side facing the flames across the street became red hot and bent of its own weight.

It was estimated that more than 25,000 persons were made jobless through the fire.

RAIL MERGER BY TAX BILL AUTHORIZED BY SENATE COMMITTEE

The Senate District committee this afternoon authorized Chairman Ball to introduce and report favorably from the committee a new bill authorizing the merger of the street railways of the District and providing for a new system of taxation for the street car companies, in accordance with the suggestions of the District Commissioners.

As soon as the bill has been prepared Senator Ball will introduce it and report it.

The new bill will contain the provisions of the bill authorizing the street railway merger, which is already on the Senate calendar and in addition to those provisions will do away with the present tax and substitute for it a tax of 50 per cent on net incomes in excess of 6 per cent and not in excess of 7 per cent and a tax of 75 per cent on net incomes in excess of 7 per cent.

DISTRICT GETS GIFT OF 18 MOTOR CYCLES

The police war on bootleggers, automobile speeders and other violators of law will be made more effective by the receipt of eighteen motor cycles from the federal government.

Commissioner Oyster was notified today by the chief co-ordinator of supplies for Uncle Sam that the Post Office Department has agreed to turn over to the local police department its surplus of motor cycle equipment.

These additional machines, representing in value more than $5,000, will be available as soon as the city officials send to Toledo a bill of lading for their shipment.

Both Commissioner Oyster and Maj. Sullivan were elated today when these tidings were received. Maj. Sullivan pointed out that eighteen more machines will practically double the present motor cycle squad, consisting of twenty-four men.

With the steady development of high-powered automobiles, it has become almost impossible for the bicycle police to apprehend speeders and whisky runners. Thus the big task has devolved principally upon the motor cycle squad.

Present Inadequacy.

When twenty-four motor cycles are divided among eleven precincts and allowance is made for men on leave, the inadequacy of the present number becomes apparent. The generous offer of the postal authorities will make possible the detailing of two more motor cycles to the precincts having large suburban territories, and at least one to each precinct.

Commissioner Oyster believes the new motor cycles will give the department a big advantage in coping with high-powered automobiles used by bootleggers.

The ninth precinct furnishes an example of the handicap under which the police find themselves in attempting to prevent smuggling liquor into the District. That precinct covers practically the entire northeast boundary of the city, with many roads leading in from Maryland.

Too Many Roads to Guard.

At the present time when the officers have reason to suspect that a whisky runner is headed this way from Maryland they cannot possibly watch all of the east-end approaches to the city and must rely largely on chance to cover the right roads. With more motor cycle equipment this handicap will be removed to a considerable extent.

The Commissioners are extremely grateful to the federal government for the spirit of co-operation shown recently in giving the municipality badly needed equipment left over from the war period.

The offer of eighteen motor cycles without cost is the second valuable contribution the government has made to the protection of life and property in Washington. A few weeks ago the War Department agreed to turn over to the fire department a varied assortment of equipment, from motor apparatus to small fire-fighting implements.

PROBE OF DIVORCE CASES HALTED UNTIL SATURDAY

ALEXANDRIA, Va., March 15.—Hearing of arguments, scheduled for today, was postponed until Saturday morning at 10 o'clock by the special committee of seven of the Alexandria Bar Association engaged in probing the divorce situation here. The postponement was made owing to the inability of Attorney John S. Barbour of Fairfax county, representing Judge Moncure, to be here, he being ill.

The commitee, on motion of Attorney J. Randall Caton, a member of the committee, adopted a resolution that Judge Moncure be requested to forego his purpose of presenting to the grand jury, selected and summoned for Friday, March 17, all matters pertaining to the divorce situation now being investigated by the committee, until a report of this committee has been filed.

The jury, however, will meet and investigate the criminal cases, and Judge Moncure probably will have them begin a probe of the divorce situation early next week.

Just after the committee adjourned, court convened and Judge Moncure called A. Clyd Gill, a Washington newspaper man, and directed Sergt. Cox to have Mr. Gill give a bond in the sum of $500 to appear before the grand jury to testify as to what he knew about divorce conditions here. Mr. Gill a short time afterward had Attorney Gardner L. Boothe, who is a member of the probe committee, go on his bond.

The court took this action because of the fact that Mr. Gill is a non-resident of the state of Virginia, his home being in Washington. The court is anxious that he appear before the grand jury.

U. S. TO SET FORTH WAR CLAIM VIEWS IN ALLIED CAPITALS

Ambassadors in London, Paris and Rome to Explain Unyielding Demand.

WILL MEET ARGUMENTS FRIENDLY, BUT FIRMLY

Demand Not to Be Pressed When Once Recognized, Views in Official Quarters Here.

BY EDWARD PRICE BELL.

By Cable to The Star and Chicago Daily News.
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LONDON, March 15.—The viewpoint of the United States touching its claim of a share of the moneys due from Germany for the maintenance of the armies of occupation on the Rhine will be represented in identical terms by the American ambassadors in London, Paris and Rome. Ambassador Harvey will see Lord Curzon Thursday, provided the British foreign minister is not too ill to attend to public business.

Admits of No Question.

The American claim will be set forth as admitting of no question in law or in morals. Unless unexpected opposition is encountered the American ambassador will go no further than to cite the facts of the situation. If arguments against the American claims are adduced they will be met in a friendly but unyielding spirit. The case of the United States rests upon a "legal tripod."

First, reimbursement for American outlays on the Rhine, as well as for those of Britain and France, was guaranteed in the terms of the armistice; second, these terms were reaffirmed in the treaty of Versailles as "armistice articles still in force"; third, the separate treaty of the United States with Germany commits Germany explicitly to recognition of all American rights under the armistice and the treaty of Versailles.

Regard Case as Strong.

These are the fundamentals of the American legal case. America's ambassadors deem them invincible.

Morally they regard the case as equally strong. While the American people were eager for the return of American troops, the government yielded to the appeals of the allies that the American Army remain on the Rhine as evidence of the solidarity of the powers that won the war.

Certain cynical and politically unintelligent persons in London are counseling the British government to take an offensive attitude on the American claim. It is impossible to believe that this advice will have any weight in Downing street, because the dullest man in the ministry could hardly fail to appreciate the peril with which it is fraught.

RECOGNITION ALONE SOUGHT.

U. S. Not Disposed to Press Claim at Present.

By the Associated Press.

Recognition by other interested governments of the rights of the United States in connection with distribution of German reparations was all that was sought at this time in the recent demand upon the allied finance ministers for payment of $241,000,000 expenses of the American army of occupation, it was stated today by a high administration official.

Having "established its case," it was said, the United States will not press further now its demands for payment of the bill.

Note Serves Notice.

Presentation of the demand last week before the allied finance ministers is regarded by this government as serving notice that its rights must be respected, it was said, and recognition of that attitude by the government was all that was desired.

There has been no protest from responsible quarters against the United States obtaining equal rights with the allied governments through operation of the separate treaty of peace with Germany, it was explained, and the matter of payment for the American forces in the Rhineland will be allowed to take its due course.

AID OF LABOR PLEDGED.

Will Assist Legion in Relief of Unemployed Veterans.

By the Associated Press.

INDIANAPOLIS, March 15.—Samuel Gompers today informed the national headquarters of the American Legion that organized labor would give every encouragement to the legion campaign to relieve unemployment among veterans of the world war. The campaign ends next Monday.

"This is a most worthy object," wrote Mr. Gompers, referring to the legion's campaign. "You know, however, that the membership of the American Federation of Labor is composed of wage earners only. While our membership cannot give employment to the unemployed members of the American Legion there is no doubt that every encouragement will be given to bring about the desired results. Thousands of members of the American Legion are also members of the trade unions and the sympathy of the wage earners will go out to those who did so much for not only our own country but for the entire world."



RENEW ATTEMPTS TO AMEND TREATY

New Proposal Provides for Calling In Other Nations for "Consideration."

For the third time the Senate defeated today an effort to amend the four-power treaty to permit participation of outside nations in international conferences over controversies arising in the Pacific.

An amendment for that purpose by Senator Pittman, democrat, Nevada, similar to two on the same subject rejected yesterday, was defeated, 50 to 27.

The treaty opponents indicated, however, that they would bring the proposal forward again later in the form of a reservation in the hope that they might secure the support of a number of senators who object to all amendments as a matter of principle.

The attempt to amend the four-power treaty so that outside nations would be called into consultation regarding Pacific controversies was renewed in the Senate today despite the defeat yesterday of two amendmnts for that purpose.

A new amendment, more limited in scope than those already rejected, was presented by Senator Pittman, democrat, Nevada. It provided that in any future controversy outside nations having interests in the Pacific would be called into conference "for consideration" of the subject. In the two previous proposals the words "for consideration and adjustment" were used and the participating powers were not limited to those having interests in the Pacific.

The practical effect of the amendment, Senator Pittman said, would be to confine the group of nationas affected to Russia, China, the Netherlands and Portugal. He explained that he offered it because of objections that yesterday's proposals were so broad as to virtually bring the whole world under the scope of the treaty.

Should such a change be made, the Nevada senator argued, it might be made by a textural amendment of the treaty and not by reservation, as some have suggested. It was indicated, however, that should all amendments be defeated, the proposition would be brought forward later in the form of a compromise reservation with the hope of gaining the support of some of those who do not favor actual amendment of the pact.

A "propaganda" favoring unqualified ratification of the four-power treaty was charged by Senator Pittman, who said that those responsible apparently were well meaning, but did not know what the pact actually contained.

"Great church bodies," he said, "represented by executive committees composed of perhaps a dozen men and claiming to represent hundreds of thousands of people are signing petitions for ratification of this treaty as it is.

"How many of those hundreds of thousands have read the treaty? How many of those Christian people do you think would ask for ratification if they knew that it contained no provision for consultation except between four powers?"

Opposed by Underwood.

Senator Underwood of Alabama, the democratic leader, opposed the amendment, although he said he was not inclined to disagree with it "in principle." To amend the treaty, he said, would be to reopen the field of negotiation and "might destroy the treaty." He pointed out that other governments refused to recognize the Russian government.

"While the United States might enter into a contract with a government we don't recognize," said Senator Underwood. "I doubt if other nations would, and that would mean delay for the treaty. It may destroy it. The amendment is not of sufficient value to take the chancer."

That the signatories had exchanged notes giving to Netherlands the benefit of the treaty was pointed out by Senator Underwood. The Netherlands, he said, did not ask to be a party to the treaty and did not request participation until after the treaty was signed.

It would be reasonable to believe,

(Continued on Page 2, Column 3.)

Today's News In Brief

Committee depicts needs of orphans in near east and appeals for funds. Page 2
Alabama Power Company accused by Representative Oliver. Page 3
Seek possible May day plot in radical's death by bomb. Page 3
Negro pours kerosene on woman and lights it. Page 3
Fosdick, former league official, supports four-power pact. Page 3
Woman civil service employes see equal rights in reclassification. Page 17
Publicity association to boost capital urged by W. B. Calloway, B. & O. passenger expert. Page 17
Storm death toll is placed at 24. Page 19
Commissioners oppose salary increase for District teachers. Page 23

"DOLLAR MARK LURING WIVES TO STEER THEIR HUSBANDS INTO JAIL."

By the Associated Press.

NEW YORK, March 15.—"Greed for diamonds and furs is the curse of the times," Judge Louis D. Gibbs of the Bronx county court declared today in suspending sentence on Saul Zukor, millinery dealer, who pleaded guilty to receiving stolen goods.

"Modern women, yes, a great majority of them," he said, "are using the dollar mark to steer their husbands into jail. Just as long as the men of the family bring home the money no questions are asked. The trouble with the man of today is that he is too eager to make money to supply his wife or daughter with diamonds and furs. He is bound to get it somehow—honestly or by criminal methods."

Judge Gibbs' condemnation of modern tendencies was delivered after Mrs. Zukor, the prisoner's wife, had been called to the stand. Attired in an expensive fur coat and her fingers covered with rings, she indignantly denied that she had knowledge of her husband's crime, though admitting that she had charge of her husband's store. Judge Gibbs accused her of being in league with her husband, and ordered her from the courtroom. He explained that sentence was suspended because the prisoner had four small children to support.

AGAINST SEPARATE UTILITIES BOARD

Col. Keller Says Little Could Be Accomplished Due to Litigation.

There is little that a separate public utilities commission could accomplish in the District as long as the valuations of several of the largest corporations are involved in litigation, in the opinion of Engineer Commissioner Keller, who is also chairman of the utilities commission.

Col. Keller voiced this belief today when asked for an expression on the proposal suggested to Congress that a utilities commission be created, not composed of the Board of Commissioners.

The chairman said the only thing which he sees could be done by a new commission that has not already been done would be to change the policy of a uniform rate of fare for both street car companies by giving each company the rate it would need to earn a reasonable return.

Duties Do Not Interfere.

The colonel indicated that he does not believe the duty of serving on the utilities commission unduly burdens the District Commissioners. For a short period of the year when rates come up for revision the Commissioners are kept busy serving in the dual capacity.

But during the balance of the twelve months, it was pointed out at the District building today, a separate utilities commission composed of three men would find little to occupy its time.

Except during the short intervals when rates are under revision, the meetings of the utilities commission consist principally of locating car stop signs, approving applications for jitneys and similar routine matters.

Officials also called attention to the fact that the utilities commission probably has passed through the busiest period of its career. The enormous task of valuing the properties of the companies has been completed, and, as the country gradually returns to normal conditions rate cases will not have to be heard so often as they were during and since the war.

Car Rate Long Unchanged.

Before the war, Col. Keller pointed out, when the nation's equilibrium was not upset, the street car rate of six tickets for 25 cents remained unchanged for many years. Nor did other utilities need changing rates.

As the country settles back to a pre-war basis the utilities also will become stabilized and require less attention from the utilities board, it is believed.

Commissioner Rudolph, who was serving his first term nine years ago when the utilities law was being drafted, believed then that the utilities board should be composed of others than the District commission. He has reiterated that view since returning to office.

BANDITS TAKE $9,000.

EDGEWATER, N. J., March 15.—Three armed bandits today stole about $9,000 from the paymaster of Kellogg, Spencer & Sons, and escaped in an automobile.

NEW STREET PAVING TO START MONDAY

Spring Period of Improvement Projects About to Begin—Repairs to Be Made.

The District engineer department will begin its spring period of street paving and repair work Monday, Maj. F. S. Benson, assistant engineer commissioner, stated today.

On that day the Cranford Paving Company expects to begin on four important resurfacing jobs, as follows:

Connecticut avenue and Columbia road, east side, from Florida avenue to California street.

C street southeast, from 2d to 3d streets.

A street northeast from 7th to 9th streets.

The Commissioners also have ordered the resurfacing of the following streets before the expiration of the current fiscal year in June:

Northwest—Seventeenth street from Massachusetts avenue to P street, $3,500; 18th street, Massachusetts avenue to P street, $2,400; E street, 10th to 11th street, $2,500; Massachusetts avenue, 18th street to Dupont Circle $9,000; Massachusetts avenue, 22d street to Sheridan Circle, $7,200; R street, Massachusetts avenue to 20th street, $10,800.

Northeast—Ninth street, Massachusetts avenue to Maryland avenue, $23,000.

Southeast—Canal street, South Capitol to E street, $2,000; D street, north side, from 2d to 3d streets, and North Carolina avenue, 3d street to Pennsylvania avenue.

Other streets have been recommended to the Commissioners for resurfacing and probably will be ordered so.

In addition to these resurfacing jobs, the engineer department will have its regular minor repair gangs at work during the spring patching the bad spots in existing streets.

SCORES FLEE RENO HOTEL

Largest Hotel Destroyed by Fire. Firemen Rescue Many.

RENO, Nev., March 15.—Scores of guests escaped from upper windows in their nightclothes when the Riverside Hotel, the largest hotel here, was destroyed by fire early this morning.

At 5 o'clock the building still was a furnace, and the ruins could not be searched, but a check was started to learn if any guests were missing. No serious injuries were reported.

The fire, believed to have started in the engine room, broke out shortly after 2 o'clock. The flames spread upward quickly and the guests, aroused by the smoke, found the stairways cut off. Most of them were rescued by firemen with ladders.

The firemen prevented the flames from spreading to other buildings, but could not save the hotel.

Several thrilling rescues were reported, among them that of two children from a blazing room. The scantily clad guests were cared for in surrounding houses. A mild night saved them much suffering from exposure.

NON-PARTISAN BLOC IN U. S. CITIZENSHIP URGED BY McADOO

LOS ANGELES, Calif., March 15.—What he termed the "intolerant partisan basis on which our government functions" was deprecated in the first speech delivered here by William G. McAdoo, former Secretary of the Treasury and director general of railroads, since he came to Los Angeles to make his home.

In a speech before the City Club he declared all matters taken before Congress or other legislative bodies were settled upon political bases, often much to the detriment of the purposes.

"What we should have in the United States," he said, "is a large body of intelligent citizens, who are not affiliated with any party and who could hold the balance of power. Such citizens would be Americans first and their check on the big parties would be most valuable."

HARD-COAL MINERS MEET OPERATORS; STRIKE PREDICTED

19 Demands of Men to Be Presented and Answer Made on Friday.

By the Associated Press.

SPRINGFIELD, Ill., March 15.—Disapproval of the appointment of a governmental commission to effect a settlement of the threatened coal strike, April 1, was expressed in a telegram sent Secretary of Labor Davis by President Frank Farrington of the Illinois Mine Workers at noon today.

NEW YORK, March 15.—Anthracite miners and operators were prepared today to begin negotiations for a new wage agreement to take the place of the two-year contract which expires at the end of this month. A large number of operators arrived to participate in the first joint conference this afternoon. A majority of the representatives of the miners comprising the scale committee have been in the city several days conferring, the last to arrive being President John L. Lewis of the international organization of the United Mine Workers.

The nineteen demands of the miners, formulated at their convention in Shamokin, Pa., in January and ratified by the international convention at Indianapolis last month, are to be formally presented to the coal operators and explained in detail by officers of the union. The operators are expected to immediately take them under consideration and make a statement of their position on Friday.

The miners are asking for a 20 per cent increase on contract rates, among other things, while the mine with other things, while the mine decrease below the present working basis.

No Referendum Taken.

It is not expected that an agreement will be reached before the end of the month, and in that event the scale committee of the hard coal workers is under instructions of the Shamokin convention to order a suspension of mining until a satisfactory agreement is in sight. A referendum on the question of suspension was not taken in the anthracite fields, the action of the convention having expressed wishes of the men. The national policy committee of the mine workers has the power to set aside a suspension, if it sees fit, but, according to union leaders here, such action is not likely. It is the opinion of miners and many of the operators that a suspension in the hard coal fields of Pennsylvania is certain. If it comes, it is expected there will be a complete cessation of production, as on two former occasions when negotiations were dragged over many weeks.

A shortage of anthracite coal is not anticipated unless the expected suspension should run into the summer, which is not looked for by the miners. The demand for coal during the winter was below normal, due to mild weather and high prices, but despite this the anthracite mines have been kept steadily at work, in contrast to those in the bituminous fields, and there is a fair supply of coal on hand, both in the big storage yards of the mining companies and in the larger retail yards of the east, it was said.

Will Resist Any Cut.

The miners enter the joint conference determined, they said, to resist with all their power any effort to reduce their present wage scale as indicated by the operators. "There must be no backward step," President Lewis has said, and the miners have declared themselves as unanimous in supporting him.

Beyond the general statement that

(Continued on Page 2, Column 1.)

SENATE TO SHELVE HOUSE BONUS BILL FOR THIS SESSION

Senior Body Expected to Heed Economic Warning of Secretary Mellon.

PRESIDENT WOULD VETO MEASURE AS IT STANDS

Representatives Consider Fall Elections and Pass on Responsibility for Issue.

BY DAVID LAWRENCE.

The House will pass a bonus bill and the Senate will shelve it for this session at least.

That is the outlook now that the House ways and means committee has received and ignored the advice of the Secretary of the Treasury, the controller of the currency and the governor of the Federal Reserve Board to the effect that the bonus bill in the form proposed would be a bad thing for the economic condition of the country.

It does not happen often that a committee so important as the ways and means summons a Secretary of the Treasury of its own political affiliation and after listening to his exposition of the Treasury's condition goes ahead in exactly the opposite direction.

It does not happen often that a repudiation of the Secretary of the Treasury is voiced by a whole body in Congress, but that is what is coming now. In a parliamentary form of government it would mean the resignation of Mr. Mellon, but the House of Representatives has passed many a bill that died in the Senate, and resignations never are in order here unless the President himself fails to stand by a cabinet officer. In this instance, the President is squarely behind Mr. Mellon, and if the Senate should follow the House a veto is certain for the bonus bill.

Maneuver for Delay.

But the Senate will not ignore Mr. Mellon's advice. Over in the cloakrooms of the upper house the word "bonus" is rarely spoken. It hangs over the Senate like impending doom. Just how the senior body will handle the question is not yet determined, but a tacit understanding seems to prevail that by one parliamentary maneuver or another something will delay passage of the bonus.

It was the Senate, which last summer blocked the bonus bill, and probably upon more words of warning from the White House the measure will be set aside until the finances of the government are in better condition. As for the issue itself, it is expected to bob up again in 1924 when the next presidential primaries are under way. By that time, however, some republican leaders hope to revise the entire revenue program and to make special provision for a fund to pay the bonus. This revision will be attempted by means of a sales tax, which Mr. Harding now openly favors for the soldier bonus. This commitment to the principle of the sales tax copes at a time when revenue laws are not being revised, but, just the same, it has brought deep satisfaction to the proponents of such tax who would have been greatly assisted a few months ago when they tried to get a presidential declaration on the subject to help them substitute a sales tax for all the other kinds of taxes which finally found their way into the 1921 revenue law.

Fordney Shuns Advice.

There is a significant bit of information, incidentally, in the statement of Representative Fordney, chairman of the House ways and means committee, that he did not expect Speaker Gillett, who is now in Florida with the Chief Executive, to bring back an informal message to the House on the bonus question. Mr. Fordney knows the President's views, and would prefer not to have them at this time. He could have had them when he visited Mr. Harding just before the latter left for Florida. The President told callers afterward that the bonus question was discussed only incidentally, and that he did not outline his views to Mr. Fordney because they were already well known.

This incident, together with Mr. Fordney's declaration that he is not expecting word from the President, is generally taken to mean that the chairman of the House ways and means committee believed it important for the success of the republican party this fall to go ahead and pass a bonus bill in the House, where 435 members of both parties are up for re-election.

Too strong opposition from the President might hinder the passage of the bonus bill in the House and spoil the record of the party there, at least, where it is ever so much more important than in the Senate, where only one-third of the membership changes in the fall elections, and of that number certain members will be re-elected irrespective of how they vote on the bonus question. The politics of the situation is to permit the House to express itself and thereby place upon the Senate and the executive the responsibility for postponement of the cash bonus.

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PLAN FOR PROCEDURE.

House Democrats Expected to Cause Some Trouble.

Speaker Gillett, before his departure for Florida with President Harding, told Chairman Fordney not to depend entirely upon a suspension of the rules as a means of getting the bonus bill before the House.

This was disclosed today by Mr. Fordney after his attention had been called to the dispatches from Palm Beach. Mr. Fordney explained that the bill could be taken up Tuesday or later under a special rule, and added that he was not opposed to full and free discussion on the floor.

"I am willing that the sunlight be turned on the bill," said the Michigan member, who will direct its course in the House. "I recall that we put the first bonus bill through under a suspension of the rules and that there was not a ripple on the water about it."

Prepare for Delay.

There is a growing sentiment among the republican members in the House against having the bill come up under suspension of the rules. Several of the recognized parliamentary authorities on the republican side are preparing themselves to delay any action upon the bonus

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BUDGET BUREAU OFFICIAL URGES $3,000,000 FOR WATER SUPPLY

Former Senator Sherman of Illinois, who worked with the budget bureau on the estimates for the District of Columbia for the fiscal year 1923, who was at the Capitol today, expressed a hope that the conferees on the District appropriation bill would approve the Senate amendments for an increase in the water supply. Senator Sherman pointed out that the appropriation for an increased water supply was imperative.

"There may be some ground for differences as to the appropriations for streets," said Senator Sherman. "We can live with muddy streets if necessary, but the city must be provided with an adequate supply of water, and it is absolutely necessary that $3,000,000 should be made available for this purpose, to be used during the next year or two."

Senator Sherman said also that he hoped the conferees would agree to the Senate amendment authorizing the erection of a home for feeble-minded persons in the District. At present, he pointed out, there is no proper institution here for caring for the feeble-minded. He said it was not economy to cut such items from the bill.

SEPARATE ROOM FOR JURY WOMEN SAID TO LEAD TO MORE MISTRIALS

Special Dispatch to The Star.

LOS ANGELES, March 15.—The "mixed jury" is having a crucial test here. Nine men and three women are about to decide the fate of Madalynne Obenchain, charged with the murder of her sweetheart, J. Belton Kennedy. It is the first time so far as known that women have sat upon a jury in judgment of another woman standing in the shadow of a death sentence.

Should the women on the Obenchain jury bring about a mistrial, as women already have done in so many criminal cases in California during the last three years, it is extremely doubtful whether mixed juries longer can be employed where a capital crime is the issue.

If California's experience counts for anything it may be stated that the communities which believe they have solved the "housing problem" for mixed juries by segregating the men and the women, are doomed to disappointment.

It has been found here that with the men and women separated in different apartments the men at times reach one decision and the women arrive at another. When the jury gets together again the differences are irreconcilable and a mistrial results.

Already there has been a mistrial in the case in which Mrs. Obenchain is concerned today. Arthur Burch was indicted jointly with her for the murder of Kennedy, but demanded a separate trial. Women predominated on the jury, which was locked up for many weary hours, men and women separately, but without avail. The breach was found to be widened when the full jury met. There was nothing to do but dismiss the jury after a very expensive and hard-fought trial.

On the segregation phase of the mixed jury problem the California legislature has done its part, even to the pink of propriety. In 1919, when women were first made eligible for jury duty, the lawmakers directed each county should provide "a room for the feminine members of the jury which shall be separate and apart from the room provided for the male members."

Rooms Lock Inside.

This provision has been lived up to in the state in letter and spirit in the deliberations of all mixed juries. In the courtroom here where the most important criminal cases are heard there is a room for the deliberations of the jurors and a stairway leading to two separate apartments above, one for women and one for men, with cots for sleeping. These dormitories are arranged so they can be locked from the inside. Juries taken to hotels for the night are quartered two in a room as a rule, with a bailiff on guard in the hall.

Presiding Judge Frank R. Willis of

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